

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Associate Director, Senior Business Analyst (Capital Markets) candidate with ~7 years bridging institutional business stakeholders and data/engineering teams across ALM, risk, and client analytics. Performs business analysis to translate complex, ambiguous requirements into precise data specifications, functional specifications, and validated outputs; holds delegated sign-off on multi-asset portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement) at Moody's Analytics. Hands-on SQL and Python, reference-data governance, risk-metric and return calculations, data validation, Agile delivery, and senior-stakeholder communication. CFA and dual MSc.

CORE SKILLS

Business Analysis & Requirements Definition • Functional Specifications & Data Requirements • Data Modeling & Data Validation (SQL) • Reference Data Governance • Risk Metrics & Return Calculations • Stakeholder Engagement & Presentation • Agile / Scrum Delivery • Python Analytics Pipelines • Excel & Data Visualization (Plotly)

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Requirements, Data Specifications & Validation

- Held delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement, ~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions before production release.
- Reviewed aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics and return calculations feeding downstream ALM and capital processes, establishing data validation and quality-control protocols.
- Escalated outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and served as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Analytics Platform Delivery & Governance

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, developing data requirements and functional specifications with data-engineering teams.
- Member of the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable, auditable Python and SQL (PostgreSQL) analytics pipelines with embedded logging and validation controls.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection, reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms.
- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, performing business analysis to scope requirements into structured development requests and validating model outputs post-deployment.
- Contributed to the successful migration of all assigned client accounts from the legacy Calypso platform to PFaroe PM.

Ernst & Young (EY)**Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation**

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and reporting frameworks.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and project-management teams on milestone delivery, requirements documentation, and regulatory-readiness processes.

Ortec Finance Canada**Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk**

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors, analyzing funding ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet risk exposures.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest-rate and funding-volatility risk under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and attribution to test allocation robustness.
- Presented ALM study findings and allocation recommendations to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients on-site.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016